

Interview with Corbin Campbell

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Tobar: And we're recording. So welcome and thank you Professor Campbell for agreeing to be a part of this project. It is Wednesday, February 24, 2021 for the Days of Resistance, Black Lives Matter in Higher Education Oral History Project. Can you please state your full name and affiliation?

Campbell: [00:00:20] Sure. So my name is Corbin Campbell and I'm Associate Dean of Academic Affairs, also Associate Professor School of Education at American University.

Tobar: And thank you again for agreeing to participate in this project. I'm really excited to have your insights as an ally to this student group during your time at Teachers College. Can you tell me a little bit about your interest and background in higher education and how that journey began for you?

Campbell: [00:00:53] Yes, I'm happy to and I just want to say this. It's such a pleasure to think back on the time working with this group, the Black Lives Matter in Higher Education Group that formed while I was TC was one of the highlights I think of my time there in so many different ways. So how I came into higher education. So I am a student that came to college and I would say I was a bit of a lost soul.

[00:01:27] Like I was not ready, you know, not ready to be in higher education and spiraling in ways that were not going to allow me to be retained. And it was the dean at the time who really stopped me in my tracks and helped me to get the support I needed to really I'm going to say change my life and be a deep support structure for me.

[00:01:57] And so because of that, I realized the power of higher education to change lives and I thought at the time that I wanted to work on the student affairs side. It was a dean of students who really helped me to rethink things and turn things around at the time. And so I went and got a master's degree at Ohio State in student affairs, and I started working in housing.

[00:02:23] And I realized that as much as I really appreciated the student affairs side I started to become really interested in research and the power of new knowledge to shape practice in higher education. And so I went back for my doctorate at the University of Maryland, and I think, you know, each one of these little steps along the way are so important to my coming to better understand what it means to support black students in higher education in particular.

[00:02:55] Because what I started to encounter was research and also just lived experiences of other students in the doctoral program, particularly black students who came into higher education not like me. Not because somebody came and helped them and supported them and changed their

life, but because they persisted through higher education despite systems that did not support them, that did not help them, that did not you know give them what they needed to succeed.

[00:03:29] And that they are now in higher education to change that. And I think that deep realization that, you know, part of my privilege as a white student was you know being able to receive the support that I needed at the time and having a dean see me not from a deficit orientation, but from an orientation of possibilities. You know, made me start to realize the deep inequities that exist in higher education. And particularly for black, brown, and indigenous students.

[00:03:58] You know that experience, you know, continued when I came on board at TC working as an assistant professor in the higher education program there. And hearing students really mostly, I'm going to say from black students in my classes who were in pain and who were faced with lacking a sense of belonging in higher education.

[00:04:32] Who were faced with the trauma of living in a society during the election of Trump and all of the racist acts that were a part of that. And the murder of Eric Garner, you know, just so much violence toward black and brown bodies while I was at TC.

[00:04:58] You know one of the things that I've been reading recently is just in the history of higher education how there's this push/pull and actually I will say Cynthia I know your work around student activism probably takes a deep look at this. But I have looked more and more about how students are typically pushing and fighting on the side of equity, and when you look at the history of higher education how administration has always come to kind of squash that and quell that.

[00:05:31] Not always, of course there's exceptions, right? And we see exceptions at many places like HBCUs and otherwise, but I'm finding more and more that there's evidence in the history of higher education of higher education being a constraining place as opposed to a liberating space. And so enter these amazing, incredible students from the higher education program who took their pain and anger and anguish from experiencing a white supremacist and racist society and industry in higher education.

[00:06:13] And said no, in fact, you know black lives matter in higher education and we're going to come together to bring voice to that. And I think I just got lucky to be in the right place at the right time when these incredible students were a part of this movement and I got to bear witness to that journey. And I think I'll just share, you know, since that time it's been a year and a half now that I've been in my associate deanship at The School of Education at American.

[00:06:44] And I'm fortunate enough to be working with a dean, Dean Cheryl Holcomb-McCoy, who is a deeply antiracist leader. And I think the

learnings during my time at TC with students and the Black Lives Matter in Higher Education group have been such a basis, such a jumping off point for my learning as I'm building my learning as an antiracist leader. And there's no doubt, you know, pain and grief in this process.

[00:07:19] But there's also some hope to see change and to believe in the possibility of change and to recognize all of the structural barriers to change simultaneously. To hold those two things simultaneously, so I guess that's a little bit of what I'd say about my background and how it connects to the group. And just how grateful I feel to the group for the students being there in that time and space, you know, to lift this voice forward.

Tobar: Thank you so much for sharing about that background. And I think it's so vital for faculty not necessarily to be in that position of like let's do something. The fact that you're conveying this idea or this ability to listen I think matters a lot listening to students. And thinking back about that time in TC, can you tell me what year that was when you entered TC as an educator? And what were your early memories as an educator at the institution like?

Campbell: [00:08:27] So it was 2012. Like I came on as assistant professor in 2012, and I think my earlier memories were the realization that there was a lot of need for students to find a space of community and they were also interested in working on research. And so I had pulled together sort of an open call for students interested in participating on a research team.

[00:08:59] And it was an incredibly diverse equity-oriented group of students who answered this call. And so I think my early experiences with that were just feeling grateful for this collaborative group. And this is true of the BLMHE group as well. You know the giving of time, you know the volunteering of time towards these efforts, you know.

[00:09:29] And the need for community around these issues. So those are some of the things that I remember. I also will tell you I remember those first students too. Just hearing students stories through higher education and that was still during the Obama years, pre-Trump, and students lived experiences. You know their individual histories, cultures, and experiences you know intersect with the graduate student experience in real ways.

[00:10:04] Ways that sometimes thwart the learning process, and actually you know the other thing that I'll reflect on is I've now had the opportunity to revise a lot of my courses that I was teaching at that time. And I feel deep regret for the lack of antiracist approaches that I had; I think coming into my first year at TC.

[00:10:32] And how ill equipped I really was to teach in an antiracist way. I still feel ill equipped, but I definitely see some progress when I look at my syllabus now, you know, compared to what it was. And I know that that's like the process of teaching and just learning about teaching. But I

do think, you know, I reflect back on just how structurally ill-equipped higher education is to produce faculty who are antiracist teachers and antiracist leaders.

[00:11:05] And this is just not what this industry is designed for at this moment in time. And it wasn't then, it still isn't.

Tobar: No thank you for sharing that. It's a nice segway into this other question that I have here about if you would be able to describe what your vision of higher education was like before TC and how that vision and your role within higher education at TC changed since then? And I feel like what you were talking about before could possibly help inform this question. Any thoughts you want to share on that?

Campbell: [00:11:41] I'm sorry. Can you share the question one more time? It's just going to give me some time to think it through.

Tobar: Sure, sure, no worries. So thinking about how you talk about how you were struggling looking in hindsight, how you regretted you weren't really informed about antiracist practices because of just basically the systemic inequity embedded within higher education. Could you describe what your vision of higher education was like before you came to TC as an educator? And how that vision in your role within higher education at TC changed since then?

Campbell: [00:12:14] Yes. That's such a good question. So I was in the doctorate before I got to TC. My dissertation was on the departmental context that shaped faculty sense of agency in their careers, right? And so I think I had the notion that context matters and that there's something about agency, autonomy, the ability of make meaning out of one's context.

[00:12:52] I think that I wasn't fully understanding constraints on agency. And I think the view that I had of higher education prior to coming to TC was I think not as fully understanding of the historical constraints.

[00:13:20] To use one of our former students at TC, to use her conceptual term here but the academic violence that takes place, you know for students. I don't know if you know Denise Dortch, Dr. Dortch, and her work, but she was an EDM student at TC when I was there in my early years and now is on the faculty at George Washington University.

[00:13:51] But I think in retrospect I didn't realize, I understood issues of equity and believed that racism was a problem. But I think I didn't fully acknowledge my own tapes that were playing, right?

[00:14:15] The ways in which as a white woman who went through a predominately white university for undergraduate, predominately white university for my masters and my doctorate, right? And I'm not a first-generation college student, right? So somebody who has a familial history, the ways in which my sources of privilege shaped my teaching and

my understandings of higher education I think I have a richer understanding of that now than I did then.

[00:14:52] And I still know I'm constantly still confronted with the ways in which my biases intersect with my practice. I guess this is maybe trite analogy, but you know the layers of the onion, right? I just feel like you know with antiracism you know and equity orientation, social justice orientation, however you want to understand it.

[00:15:16] It's like very every time I think I've gotten to the next layer, I just realize how big the onion is [laughter], you know. So that's a little bit about that and I think now the thing that I've learned the most during my time at TC that sort of started to evolve during my time at TC and is now deeply poignant as an administrator is that the only way to do this work. The answers to a racist higher education structure will not come from my, you know, white administrator brain, right?

[00:15:47] They will come from listening, deeply listening to students especially black, brown, and indigenous students. And especially those students that I feel like I don't first understand, right? So like anytime I encounter a perspective where I'm like gosh I just can't understand where the student is coming from, that's where I need to be listening most, right? And so I feel like I started to get that by listening to the to the incredible students in our Black Lives Matter in Higher Education group and other TC students.

[00:16:20] I'm going to say especially the black students that I encountered in that group were just so courageous. And the emotional burden that they carried to carry the torch on this was just huge. And so I'm grateful to have the privilege to learn from that. And that continues to be the case at AU, right? That's the same things that's happening. There's a black graduate students group in our policy and leadership program.

[00:16:50] And everything that I feel like I've learned in the past year about my practice has been from listening to that group. You know, hopefully that's a little about what you were hoping to –

Tobar: No, that was absolutely articulate. Thank you so much. And thinking about that time as you were starting off right after your doctorate, you come to TC as an assistant professor. What goal did you have in mind to accomplish while you were at TC as an educator? Definitely you've expressed a lot about your research, but what were you hoping to achieve during your tenure at TC?

Campbell: [00:17:29] That is such an interesting question because I feel like I haven't ever really thought about like my goal as an educator at large, right? Like I think about my goal for the program or the goal for these courses, but that's a really interesting question, right, which is like what is your goal as an educator at large? And you were asking for my time at TC, because I think maybe it's changed a little bit now. But I think for my time at TC I

would've said at the time that my goal as an educator would be to have all students in my class feel a sense of belonging in my classroom.

[00:18:09] And to be able to achieve the goals that they come with. So I think that's probably what I would have said then. Now I would add to that list that my goal as an educator would be to confront structural inequality in the classroom. And I think, you know, I don't know if you're familiar with Gorski's work, but I'll send it to you.

[00:18:37] It's wonderful Cynthia, but there's some really interesting work around like equity detours and one of the ones that I've been confronting in myself, well there's several. Like pacing-for-privilege, like oh some students aren't ready to confront structural inequality. You know, that's not a good excuse, right? We need to be you know pacing for equity. But, you know, one of the things that I think about is like the idea that everyone has a sense of belonging.

[00:19:10] Like right now in my classroom I want to create a space where students, especially students who have typically been voiceless in higher education, feel that they can have voice. And sometimes that actually makes students who typically have had voice uncomfortable, right? So I think I value more the uncomfortability than I did at the time. That that uncomfortability is really deeply important to the work of equity, so I'm still learning on that front.

Tobar: Thank you for that. Can you tease out a little bit more what you mean about the uncomfortableness? And what transitioned between your time at TC to where you are now in regards to being able to approach or feel comfortable with approaching the uncomfortableness?

Campbell: [00:19:54] That's a good question. So I think when I was at TC I felt fairly comfortable approaching the uncomfortable with regard to my own biases. So there were a lot of times that students might come to me and they would make me think about my own practice. And that was OK with me. Like I was OK with being uncomfortable and being told that like I was missing the mark on antiracism. And I always learned from that. The piece that I think I wasn't fully uncomfortable with when I was at TC was allowing students in this space to be uncomfortable, although maybe got a little better with that over time.

[00:20:26] But now, oh my gosh Cynthia I will tell you there is no way that we would be able to get to an antiracist space in the School of Education without uncomfortability. And I'll just give one example. This is on the faculty level, not on the student level, but this is all about changing higher education, right? So many times in faculty meetings across the nation, this is not particular to AU. It is mostly white faculty speaking up, right?

[00:20:56] We see that regularly in many faculty meetings. And so as a part of the antiracist efforts that we've been doing in the School of

Education where I am now we have made a lot of space for our black and brown faculty to have voice. And there was a faculty meeting where I would say it was 90% black and brown faculty speaking at this meeting organically.

[00:21:28] So this is not like lining up these folks to speak. It was a lot of empty space in the faculty meeting, and it was largely our black and brown faculty speaking up. And can I tell you how many emails I got from our only white faculty, from white faculty after that, you know, questioning whether it was a safe space, right? And so to me I hear that, I hear the uncomfortability and I'm not trying to say that if that was a steady state.

[00:21:56] If it was always going to be the case that certain faculty did not feel safe, that would be something we need to address. But I'm fully comfortable with having one faculty meeting or even like moments here and there where folks feel a little I'm going to say unsafe because it's hard, right? It's really hard work to hear voices that we're not used to hearing in a way that maybe we're not used to hearing it, you know? That's hard work and that's the deep work of changing culture I think.

[00:22:28] So that's just one example.

Tobar: And that's a great example, thank you. Going back to like the role of faculty, and it's so interesting that you mentioned that with your AU experience. Going back to TC and how faculty value diversity, what were your thoughts? Do you believe that faculty and students at TC valued diversity at the institution? Why or why not? Do they provide any kind of support and if so what kind from your perspective as an educator at the institution previously?

Campbell: [00:23:03] Cynthia absolutely. I should say that I feel like TC set me up so well to be an equity advocate in my new space. You know I think back about how, I should say there's variation, right? So like TC is a big school of education and it's uneven, right? So I just want to acknowledge that. So other faculty might have had a different experience, right?

[00:23:33] But I did feel in the higher education program that there was a constant push to thinking about issues of equity, and it's funny because I've said like looking back I wish I was more antiracist. But even in the space that we were in I feel like we were constantly talking about issues of equity. And that ran from, you know, within courses all the way through to our program meetings when we talked about our program meetings.

[00:24:05] And we would talk about how to support particular students. We would talk about are we recruiting the right way to make sure that our students of color are, you know, deeply supported in that process. You know, we talked about it through faculty recruiting although that was an issue that we needed to examine because as you know when I was there the three tenure [unintelligible 00:24:27] faculty were all white faculty. But there was a sense of commitment.

[00:24:34] There was a sense of commitment and when students came to us with these ideas of like what we needed to do to help black and brown students be more supported, there wasn't a question. You know, there was a ready acceptance and supportive environment and I do attribute a lot of that to Dr. Noah Drezner who I think as program director has an approach to deeply supporting equity issues. And has a real commitment to students of color in the program.

[00:25:07] So I will say, you know, one of the things I missed when I left TC was going into meeting where that would be the focus and other issues would come up like finances would come up. Admissions would come up. Accreditation would come up, but the focus and the center was on important equity issues among our students. And I have been in spaces now and there some spaces like this at TC as well.

[00:25:37] But I've been in spaces now where I feel like I have to bring the equity voice. You know, like I'll be in on a finance meeting and I need to bring the equity voice to that. Or I'm in on an accreditation meeting and I bring the equity voice. So I think I was really set up well from the TC faculty to have equity be the center and everything else kind of revolve around it.

Tobar: And from your perspective as an educator what barriers exist that prevent TC, in your opinion, from leveraging the differences and being inclusive to all students? Like what's the work that has left to be done?

Campbell: [00:26:20] Well Cynthia I worry about speaking to that since it's been a couple years. So I don't know what's been done, you know, since that time. I do think, you know, when I was there even though there was an openness, students you know formed this group because they were suffering. So that's the issue is that the outcome has not been achieved. You know, our black and brown students still were surviving in a society.

[00:26:52] Oh my goodness, and actually I know TC has made some strides on this, but you know the naming of buildings at TC you know being named after historical figures that were very problematic. And so grappling with and acknowledging I think the past and what the means for the present would, and I think is a big step forward for the institution. Here's another example, grappling with tenure structures, right?

[00:27:24] Because we know that tenure structures, although I do believe in the promise and possibility of tenure I see how the peer review system and the tenure system reinforces and reifies status quo, right? It does not promote innovation in higher education, research, or pedagogy. Now I thought maybe I won't have anything to say on this one, but now I can think of a hundred things [laughter].

[00:27:54] But I think, you know, how we evaluate teaching, right? We know that student teaching evaluations are deeply biased by race and

gender. And yet we still use that as the primary mode to evaluate teaching. Also let's talk about how TC is a highly ranked school of education and we know that ranking systems perpetuate problematic structures that reify white supremacy across institutions, right?

[00:28:24] Because the institutions that have more faculty of color and more students of color are more prevalent among lower ranked institutions. I mean the problem is that TC is part of society, and our society is racist.

Tobar: So thinking about that, and you spoke so articulately about this before. It may seem like it's almost covering the same ground, but how do you believe your own race affected your ability to succeed as a faculty member, as a professor, educator at TC?

Campbell: [00:29:03] That is a great question. So I think I could probably speak to the moon about this. Because, you know, the truth is that you know higher education is a field where relationships matter deeply, right? And simply my placement at TC I think had to do, you know, perhaps there was something about the quality of what I was doing at the time.

[00:29:33] But also I was so fortunate to be that I got my doctorate at the University of Maryland and so a PWI, and had a mentor a wonderful mentor who was also a white woman with kids like me, right? And so I think had the same white knapsack that I had, you know, and that mentor that I had was also good colleagues with Professor Anna Neumann.

[00:30:07] And, you know, hard for me to know exactly what would've happened if I were not white in this space. But do I think that my identity as a white woman intersected with my ability to get the position and my ability. Another piece is that, you know, I was a quantitative researcher and so had the ability to pump out more publications which is valued in the tenure structure.

[00:30:36] And we know that the framing of math and science often is framed in white supremacist ways, right? So there's not at all that there's any actual ability differences, but there are deep issues related to stereotype threat, related to the ways in which this material is presented in a status quo way that reifies white culture, right?

[00:31:05] So the fact that I was a quantitative researcher, and the fact that as I look back and know even from my undergraduate, right? Like we really have to look along the entire pipeline and oh my gosh. You're getting me going, but I attended a magnet school. So I was identified as GT, right? And we know how deeply racist those structures are.

[00:31:36] I went to a GT high school, right? And how that prepares test takers and so it's just you know as I look back on my own history, you know, the white supremacy that you know is deeply embedded in all of these educational structures from educational assessments to you know

being identified as GT and not having an IEP, for example, whereas a lot of times for students of color that's flipped.

[00:32:07] You know, to going to a PWI to the fact that that dean didn't see me as a delinquent but instead saw me as someone with promise who needed help, right? That if I were a student of color that might not have happened all the way through to the relationships with mentors that eventually helped me. Yes, yes, this is part of the problem with higher education that makes it inequitable, and I'm for better or worse of that a product of that.

Tobar: And so then I think this is a wonderful way to segway into your involvement with BLMHE, with Black Lives Matter in Higher Education. How do you recall how you felt being involved with them during the early time as it was being formed? And how do you recall it affecting you at the time?

Campbell: [00:32:58] I think the affect was just, I just remember sitting in one of the first meetings and I think one of the first things that we did or that the student leaders at the time did was ask students if they were willing to share their experiences in higher education. And I was one of the few white people in the room, which is also another thing to tease out is that it often is students of color who are supporting these initiatives, right? And faculty of color, you know, who are in higher education promoting equity.

[00:33:31] But anyways, so I was one of the only white people in the room and I just remember feeling so privileged to bear witness to, and hear you know the lived experiences of these students going through higher education that did not at all look like my experiences, right? And just the continued, you know, deep realization of the role that privilege and power played in my entire trajectory.

[00:34:04] And the realization of the responsibility then that I have to support change and to put others in places where they are supported. Put others in places where they're the ones who are seen, where their research is seen, right? It was humbling and motivating to be in that space.

Tobar: And how did that relationship form? How did it begin? And how did you get invited into that room?

Campbell: [00:34:43] So I think and Cynthia this is going to be terrible because there are so many murders of black bodies by police during the time that I was at TC that I can't be sure that I'm getting the right one being the starter, so just know that. But I believe that it was around the time of Eric Garner.

[00:35:14] And I just remember emailing Noah and the two of us agreeing that, you know, we had to hear from students, and I think a few students reached out to us. And we all just said, you know, what can we do? And the students took off. You know, they just started brainstorming you know what we could do, and they were so thoughtful.

[00:35:43] You know, everything from the relational. So what I just described was like the relational piece of being in a room together and hearing each other's lived experiences. But then there was also the symbolic, right? Like you know I know this sounds silly, but you know the sweatshirts with the Black Lives Matter in Higher Education logo and how that went like viral through NASPA and otherwise. And even at ASHE, that there was a need for this kind of group in the higher education space and it was happening at TC.

[00:36:16] But there was a broader need for it and the students were so thoughtful about how to connect it to Columbia's history. Like I remember we had the professor over at Columbia who was doing some of the deep digging around Columbia's history, you know, come to talk to our students and we had a professor come to talk to us about the intersection with mental health and how we don't have enough counselors of color to support the deep and important mental health needs of students who are emotionally burdened by being in a racist society.

[00:36:52] And having to be the only ones fighting for antiracism, right? And just the toll of the cumulative experiences of oppression. And so I mean I think the students really just like drove that in incredible and meaningful ways. And I guess maybe Noah and I just provided an organizational home I guess I would say, you know.

[00:37:22] But it was the students that were driving the intellectual and emotional space.

Tobar: And could you describe I guess seeing it take off in that time period? Could you share some insights on what you observed going on at that time? They were definitely fulfilling that need, not just at TC but at higher education related conferences. What else did you see unfold at TC and particularly within the [unintelligible 00:37:52] program at that time?

Campbell: [00:37:55] So Cynthia this connects so much to I think what was more broadly going on in the field of higher education. And I can't remember if you took Coordinating Seminar with me or not. Yes, OK, so one of the things we do in the Coordinating Seminar is we read ASHE presidential addresses over several years. And, you know, what you can see from these presidential addresses is that prior to I don't know.

[00:38:31] I'm not going to get the exact year right, so just know that. But like somewhere in the you know early 2000 teens, you know 13, 14. I'm forgetting exactly where, you know, prior to that point with the exception of Anna, so we'll put Anna to the side just a second because she was a president during that time. But there was a lack of focus on antiracism I would say in those speeches, right? And then all of a sudden and definitely by 2016, 17 well I don't remember. There's a few blips [laughter].

[00:39:04] But all this to say that there was a movement in the broader field I think to think better about issues of race. And because there was, you know, such a disconnect before that. And our students were not even knowing that they were sensing like this broader movement that was needing to take shape. And there was more of a feeling of hope.

[00:39:31] I think, you know, I remember back that prior to BLMHE starting there was, and I won't share which student this was and obviously this is their own story. But there was at least one black student in the higher education program that I think was like waffling on whether it was the right thing to stay because they just felt a lack of sense of belonging and a lack of understanding. And this student ultimately ended up being a part of this group.

[00:40:01] And found a wonderful place in this community and graduated and is going on to do amazing things. And I obviously won't, you know, share more because I don't want to identify this student. But I think, you know, one of the things that was so exciting about being part of that early moment was realizing that there was a need for this community and there wasn't a space for this before. And all of a sudden the space existed, and it just deeply solidified a sense of belonging for those students.

Tobar: And could you describe what your vision of activism was before becoming an ally within BLMHE as a faculty member? And how has that vision and your role within the different vision of activism changed since then?

Campbell: [00:40:52] So I think that before BLMHE and before my current role, so I did a bunch of learning through the BLMHE process which has like fostered the next level of learning. So I think that connection is important. But I would say before all of that, I was a much more like change within the system kind of activist like understanding. And I mentioned this earlier, but I think it is the biggest learning which is that when the system itself is flawed, you know, the only way to change is to hear voices that are not privileged in the system, right?

[00:41:31] That wouldn't otherwise succeed in the system, and so I think you know learning from BLMHE, and hearing students voices and seeing the change that can result from that has been such a catalyst for knowing that the only way as an administrator that we're going you know to be able to form a school of education that will be as antiracist as we want to be is to let all of our initiatives start with the student voice.

[00:42:03] So I think that has been the biggest shift. So policies are also important, right? So it's not just individual change, but it's that policies can be driven by student voice, right? That policy change needs to happen and change from within the system needs to happen. But that needs to be rooted in student voices and particularly black, brown, and indigenous students as well.

Tobar: And one final question before we run out of time, because I want to be considerate to your time. What are some of your thoughts on how student movements continue to inform and influence culture and politics as we continue to fight racial inequity and inequality in higher Ed?

Campbell: [00:42:46] Cynthia I am convinced it is the only way. I'm convinced it's the only way that we will move the needle is students pushing administrators like myself to do things that we would never do or we would never think or we would never understand as part of our mission. As part of what higher education is supposed to do without these students. I'm so informed by the history.

[00:43:16] Actually Cynthia if you haven't read this book you so need to read it. Eddie Cole, I don't know if you've read it, The Campus Color Line. This book has like really opened my eyes so much to the ways in which administrators just clamp down on possibility, you know? Not all the time, there's some presidents in here that are doing the opposite.

[00:43:46] Actually, you know, for me as a white administrator the thing that's so unfortunate is that like almost all of the liberating administrators are faculty of color and I need new models, you know? But I think, you know, my belief is that you know in every single one of the cases that I've read about in history where there was deep change to support antiracism and to support equity it's been student driven. It has been because students, you know, think about the hunger strike, right, that happened in Missouri, right?

[00:44:16] And how the president resigned after that, right? And that started from one higher education student taking that very big stance, and then the football team joining. And the student body swelling around this, right? At a time when the administration was like under the rug, under the rug, you know? So it's the most important thing. You know when we look at higher education as an oppressive system and we look at higher education as, you know, a place that constrains opportunity for many.

[00:44:49] I think the one piece that where I see like the liberating possibility is in student culture. Like that's probably where it's at.

Tobar: So great. Thank you so much Corbin. I think we're done. Do you have any final words you want to share before we wrap up?

Campbell: [00:45:08] No Cynthia. I just want to thank you for the opportunity and I'm so pleased that you are like chronicling this journey. And I actually when we're done here I would love to hear what the group has taken on since. Because I can only imagine during this past year, how more important that group has been.

Tobar: Right, absolutely. Thank you so very much Corbin, thank you.

Campbell: [00:45:31] Thank you Cynthia.

[End of recorded material 00:45:33]